Topic 43 — International Environmental Agreements

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

UNFCCC (यूएनएफसीसीसी) | Kyoto (क्योटो) Protocol | Paris Agreement (पेरिस समझौता) | CBD | Ramsar (रामसर) | CITES (साइट्स) | Bonn Convention (CMS) | Basel | Rotterdam | Stockholm Convention | Minamata

Sources baked in: UNFCCC; CBD; Ramsar; CITES; UNEP; MoEFCC; UPPCS PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ High — Montreal≠Kyoto; treaty↔issue; Ramsar UP traps; Stockholm 1972≠POPs 2001 **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- Twin of Agreements & Conferences — COP / listing CA; treaty ladder identical.
- Ramsar India **~100** / UP **12** baseline unless a stem cites a later official total.

43.1 UNFCCC

Identity: 1992 Rio framework | Stabilize GHGs | COP | Bonn secretariat

- The **UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (जलवायु परिवर्तन) (UNFCCC)** was opened at **Rio 1992**.
- Goal: stabilize greenhouse gas concentrations to prevent dangerous climate interference.
- Holds annual **COP** meetings; secretariat in **Bonn, Germany**.
- Parent framework for **Kyoto Protocol** and **Paris Agreement** (पेरिस समझौता).
- Does **not** itself set the Kyoto Annex targets or Paris NDCs — those are later instruments.

Logic: UNFCCC = climate framework. IPCC (आईपीसीसी) = science body (Topic 42).

43.2 Kyoto Protocol

Identity: 1997 | Binding Annex-I targets | CDM / carbon markets | ≠ Montreal

- The **Kyoto Protocol (1997)** (क्योटो प्रोटोकॉल) set **legally binding emission reduction targets** for **Annex-I (developed) countries**.
- Flexible mechanisms: **CDM**, Joint Implementation, and Emissions Trading — origin of **carbon credits**.
- Climate mitigation treaty — **not** ozone (Montreal) and **not** “save water.”

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q35

Climate change mitigation agreement:

Options: A. Montreal Protocol (मॉन्ट्रियल प्रोटोकॉल) B. Ramsar C. Kyoto Protocol D. CITES

Show answer

Ans: C

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q132

NOT correctly matched:

Options: A. Cartagena — Biosafety B. Stockholm — POPs C. Montreal — Ozone D. Kyoto — Save water

Show answer

Ans: D — Kyoto = climate/GHG.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q125

Carbon credit (कार्बन क्रेडिट) concept originated from:

Show answer

Kyoto Protocol

> **Logic:** Montreal = ozone. Kyoto = climate.

43.3 Paris Agreement

Identity: 2015 COP21 | Universal NDCs | Well below 2°C / pursue 1.5°C | Force 2016

- The **Paris Agreement (2015)** (पेरिस समझौता) applies to **all parties** through **Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs)**.
- Aims to hold warming **well below 2°C** and pursue **1.5°C**.
- Entered into force in **2016**.
- Differs from Kyoto's Annex-I-only binding model — bottom-up pledges with global stocktake.
- India's NDC/net-zero policy track sits under Paris (Topics 10/34).

> **Logic:** Paris ≠ Kyoto clone. NDCs are nationally determined.

43.4 Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)

Identity: 1992 Rio | Three objectives | Nagoya ABS | Cartagena biosafety

- **CBD** opened at **Rio 1992** with three objectives: **conservation**, **sustainable use**, and **fair benefit-sharing** of genetic resources.
- **Cartagena Protocol** = biosafety / LMOs.
- **Nagoya Protocol (2010)** = Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS).
- India implements CBD via the **Biological Diversity Act 2002** (जैव विविधता अधिनियम 2002) (NBA/SBBs/BMCs).
- Biodiversity Day **22 May** commemorates CBD text adoption.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q132

Cartagena Protocol — Biosafety is a **correct** match.

> **Logic:** CBD ≠ CITES. CBD = biodiversity framework; CITES = trade.

43.5 Ramsar Convention

Identity: 1971 | Wetlands | Wise Use | 2 February | UP geography traps

- The **Ramsar Convention (1971)** (रामसर कन्वेंशन) conserves wetlands of international importance under **"Wise Use."**
- **World Wetlands Day (विश्व आर्द्रभूमि दिवस) = 2 February** (Ramsar adoption date).
- India has about **100** Ramsar sites (**Tamil Nadu (नाडु)** leads state counts; **UP 12**, **Punjab 6** among high counts).
- **Montreux Record** = Ramsar sites with adverse / likely adverse ecological change from human interference.
- Negative geography: **Rudrasagar = Tripura**; **Sultanpur NP = Haryana** — not UP.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q58

Consider the following Ramsar sites:

1. Sarsai Nawar
2. Samaspur
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

Which of the above are **not** located in Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)?

A. 1 and 2 B. 3 and 4 C. 1 and 3 D. 2 and 4

Show answer

Logic: UP Ramsar geography — which listed sites are **outside** Uttar Pradesh. **Ans: B.** **Rudrasagar Lake** is in **Tripura**; **Sultanpur National Park** is in **Haryana**. **Sarsai Nawar** and **Samaspur** are Ramsar sites in **UP**. **Trap:** Treating every listed wetland as a UP site because India has many Ramsar wetlands.

> **Logic:** Ramsar = wetlands, not forests or ozone.

43.6 CITES

Identity: 1973 Washington | Wildlife trade | Appendices I–III | ≠ IUCN

- **CITES** regulates **international trade** in endangered wild fauna (प्राणीजात) and flora (वनस्पति).
- Uses **Appendices I, II, III** by trade-threat level.
- Adopted (अंगीकृत) **1973 (Washington)** — not a Rio 1992 product.
- **World Wildlife Day (विश्व वन्यजीव दिवस) = 3 March** (CITES adoption date).
- IUCN Red List assesses extinction risk; CITES regulates trade.

> **Logic:** CITES ≠ CMS. Trade ≠ migration focus.

43.7 Bonn Convention (CMS)

Identity: 1979 | Migratory species | Habitat (वास स्थान) corridors | Bonn

- The **Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS / Bonn Convention, 1979)** protects migratory species across range states.
- Focuses on **migration routes and habitats**, not commercial trade permits like CITES.
- Secretariat association with **Bonn, Germany** (name fact).

> **Logic:** CMS = migration. CITES = trade.

43.8 Basel Convention

Identity: 1989 | Transboundary hazardous waste | Prior notice / control

- The **Basel Convention (1989)** (बासेल कन्वेंशन) controls **transboundary movements of hazardous wastes** and their disposal.
- Aims to reduce hazardous waste generation and prevent dumping on weaker states.
- Part of the BRS chemicals/waste cluster with Rotterdam and Stockholm.

> **Logic:** Basel = hazardous **waste** shipment, not wildlife trade.

43.9 Rotterdam Convention

Identity: 1998 | PIC | Hazardous chemicals in trade | FAO + UNEP

- The **Rotterdam Convention (1998)** (रॉटरडैम कन्वेंशन) uses **Prior Informed Consent (PIC)** for certain hazardous chemicals and pesticides in international trade.
- Jointly administered by **FAO** and **UNEP** (संयुक्त राष्ट्र पर्यावरण कार्यक्रम).
- Does not ban all listed chemicals globally; it ensures importing countries are informed and consent.

> **Logic:** Rotterdam = PIC chemicals. Basel = waste. Stockholm = POPs.

43.10 Stockholm Convention

Identity: 2001 | POPs | DDT/PCBs etc. | ≠ Stockholm 1972 (स्टॉकहोम सम्मेलन) conference

- The **Stockholm Convention (2001)** targets **Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs)** — long-lived toxic chemicals (e.g. certain pesticides, PCBs, dioxins).
- Seeks elimination or restriction of listed POPs.
- **Not** the same as the **Stockholm Conference 1972** that created UNEP.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q132

Stockholm Convention — Persistent organic pollutant is a **correct** match.

> **Logic:** Stockholm POPs 2001 ≠ Stockholm Environment (पर्यावरण) Conference 1972.

43.11 Minamata Convention

Identity: 2013 | Mercury | Named after Japan disaster | India ratified

- The **Minamata Convention (2013)** (मिनामाता संधि) controls **mercury** use, emissions, and releases across the life cycle.
- Named after **Minamata disease** (mercury poisoning) in Japan.
- Covers products, processes, artisanal gold mining, and emissions to air/water/land.
- India ratified around **2018** (CA fact in many banks).

> **Logic:** Minamata = mercury. Basel = hazardous waste generally.

Treaty ↔ Issue Matrix

Treaty	Year	Issue
Ramsar	1971	Wetlands
CITES	1973	Wildlife trade
CMS (Bonn)	1979	Migratory species
Basel	1989	Hazardous waste
UNFCCC	1992	Climate framework
CBD	1992	Biodiversity
Kyoto	1997	Climate (Annex-I)
Rotterdam	1998	PIC chemicals
Stockholm	2001	POPs
Minamata	2013	Mercury
Paris	2015	Climate (NDCs)

Also remember (trap pair): Montreal 1987 = **ozone** (not on this syllabus list, but frequent distractor).